

ypersetup colorlinks=true, linkcolor=black, filecolor=magenta, urlcolor=cyan,

\headThe Carnival of Echoes

wenvironmentmechanics

wenvironmentnpc[1]

tem[1]

wenvironmentlocation[1]

tem[1]

wenvironmentencounter[1]

tem[1]

The Carnival of Echoes

A Fate's Edge Adventure for Tiers III

Adventure Overview

Title: The Carnival of Echoes
Level: Tiers III
Length: 34 Sessions
Theme: Psychological horror, identity, memory, the price of desire

Core Premise

1.1 What is happening?

A traveling carnival that grants wishes is stealing memories and identities from visitors, leaving hollow shells behind.

1.2 Why now?

The carnival arrives in town tonight for a threeday festival, and its malevolent attraction grows stronger with each victim it plans to consume the entire town's collective memories by the final night.

1.3 Why the PCs?

Each PC received a mysterious invitation to the carnival, and one of them has been having prophetic dreams about it. Local authorities are mysteriously absent or unresponsive.

Setting Tone

2.1 Location: Millhaven

A riverside town during its annual Harvest Festival:

Smell: Cinnamon and roasting chestnuts mixed with something metallic **Sound:** Calliope music that sounds slightly offkey, distant carnival barker's voice **Architecture:** Victorianera buildings with paper lanterns, blackandgold tents on outskirts **Culture:** Closeknit farming community with superstitions about "traveling folk" **Sight:** Strange shadows that don't match their owners in evening light

2.2 Tone and Theme

Psychological horror with elements of wonder and melancholy. Themes of identity, memory, and the price of desire.

2.3 Environmental Pressures

tem The carnival only operates at night tem Town curfew enforced by mysterious carnival "security" tem Increasing difficulty distinguishing real memories from false ones tem Growing paranoia as townspeople become "hollowed"

large3 Key NPCs

3.1 Mayor Elena Vasquez

Mayor Elena Vasquez tem[Role:] Questgiver, desperate mother tem[Goal:] Save her town and her missing daughter tem[Fear:] Losing her remaining family and reputation tem[Method:] Gathering evidence while maintaining public order tem[Secret:] Made a wish 20 years ago that started this curse tem[Connection:] Knows one PC's family or has information they need tem[Skills:] Command 3, Insight 2, Sway 3 tem[Position:] Desperate (missing daughter), Controlled with player help tem[DV for Help:] 3 (mutual benefit), 4 (neutral), 5+ (suspicious)

3.2 Granny Moira Thornfield

Granny Moira Thornfield tem[Role:] Local ally, keeper of old knowledge tem[Age:] 153 (appears 70s) tem[Goal:] Protect town's children and uncover truth tem[Fear:] Becoming like her hollowed neighbors tem[Method:] Folk magic and local knowledge tem[Secret:] Has seen this carnival before, centuries old tem[Connection:] Offers sanctuary and information to PCs tem[Skills:] Lore 4, Arcana 3, Insight 3 tem[Position:] Dominant (ancient knowledge), Controlled under direct threat tem[DV for Information:] 4 (proper respect), 5 (neutral), 6+ (hostile)

3.3 Hollowed Townsfolk

Hollowed Townsfolk tem[Type:] Afflicted NPCs (Cap 2) tem[Tags:] [HOLLOW], [CONFUSED], [LOYAL] tem[Description:] Former townspeople with stolen memories tem[Behavior:]

tem Speak in fragmented sentences about "beautiful dreams" tem Protect carnival without understanding why tem Fear return of painful memories

tem[Weaknesses:] Vulnerable to memory restoration, confused by contradiction tem[Tactics:] Subtle sabotage, misinformation, emotional manipulation tem[Position:] Controlled (normal), Desperate when threatened

3.4 Carnival Master (Mr. Dram)

Carnival Master (Mr. Dram) tem[Type:] Ancient Outsider (Cap 5) tem[Tags:] [DREAM], [MEMORY], [ILLUSION], [FEED] tem[Description:] Construct of collective forgotten memories tem[Goal:] Collect 1000 souls' memories to ascend to godhood tem[Fear:] Being forgotten himself tem[Method:] Manipulation through desire and fear tem[Secret:] Made from previous victims' forgotten dreams tem[Connection:] Knows each PC's deepest desires and fears tem[Abilities:]

tem Memory manipulation and theft tem Illusion creation based on desires tem Feed on forgotten dreams tem Partial existence outside normal reality

tem[Position:] Dominant (carnival domain), Controlled when plan disrupted tem[DV for Confrontation:] 6 (direct), 5 (ritual), 4 (preparation)

large4 Carnival Lieutenants

4.1 Madame Zara The Fortune Teller

Madame Zara tem[Role:] Desire reader and wish trap creator tem[Skills:] Insight 4, Sway 3, Arcana 2 tem[Abilities:] Reads victims' desires, creates perfect wish traps tem[Position:] Controlled (carnival operations), Desperate when exposed tem[DV for Information:] 4 (proper approach), 5 (neutral), 6+ (hostile)

4.2 Bull Carson The Strongman

Bull Carson tem[Role:] Enforcer through intimidation and violence tem[Skills:] Skirmish 4, Command 2, Athletics 3 tem[Abilities:] Physical intimidation, memory suppression through fear tem[Position:] Dominant (physical threat), Controlled under strategy tem[DV for Combat:] 5 (direct), 4 (tactical), 3 (tricked)

4.3 The Twins Carousel Operators

The Twins tem[Role:] Memory thieves through hypnotic rides tem[Skills:] Craft 3, Arcana 3, Subterfuge 2 tem[Abilities:] Literally spin memories away, hypnotic influence tem[Position:] Controlled (carnival operations), Desperate when machinery threatened tem[DV for Sabotage:] 4 (technical), 5 (direct), 3 (misdirection)

large5 Villain's Plan

5.1 Ultimate Goal

To collect 1,000 souls' worth of memories to ascend to godhood, becoming the eternal keeper of forgotten dreams.

5.2 Why Not Easily Stopped

The carnival exists partially outside normal reality and feeds on the desires that draw people to it. Destroying it requires breaking the collective belief in its magic.

5.3 Plan Phases

Setup (Night 1): Carnival arrives, begins subtle memory collection through "free" wishes. Victims seem happier but lose small memories.

tem Advance Hollowing Timer +1 tem Gain 23 Memory Fragments tem Establish carnival presence in town

Escalation (Night 2): More aggressive collection, "hollowed" townspeople begin to act strangely. The carnival expands, offering more tempting wishes.

tem Advance Hollowing Timer +2 tem Hollow 35 key townspeople tem Introduce Midpoint Twist (PC memory compromise)

Crisis (Night 3): Final ritual to consume all remaining memories in town. Hollowed townsfolk become actively hostile to interference.

tem Advance Hollowing Timer to Full tem Final confrontation with Carnival Master tem Resolution choice determines ending

large6 Player Choices

6.1 First Three Meaningful Choices

tem Investigate the carnival's arrival and strange effects (Investigation + Notice vs DV 3)
 tem Confront a hollowed friend/family member for information (Social challenge, DV 4) tem
 Accept a tempting wish from the carnival to gain an advantage (Command + Spirit vs DV 4)

6.2 Secondary Choices

tem Rescue specific townspeople before they're fully hollowed (Extended challenge, DV 5) tem
 Choose which memories to sacrifice to gain carnival knowledge (Lore + Insight vs DV 4) tem
 Decide whether to destroy the carnival or try to reform it (Moral choice with consequences)

6.3 Choice Consequences

tem Accepting wishes makes PCs more vulnerable to memory manipulation (+1 SB on memory-related rolls) tem Rescuing townspeople gains allies but alerts the carnival (Advance Hollowing Timer +1) tem Destroying without understanding may leave fragments (New adventure seed)

large7 Core Mystery

7.1 Central Unknown

How the carnival steals memories and what happens to them, plus the Carnival Master's true identity and weakness.

7.2 Investigation Clues

Three Clue Rule The Carnival's True Nature:

tem **Investigation:** Research reveals pattern of memorytheft across different towns (Lore + Investigation vs DV 5) tem **Social:** Partially hollowed NPC reveals carnival feeds on forgotten dreams (Sway + Insight vs DV 4) tem **Occult:** Magical investigation shows partial existence in dream realm (Arcana vs DV 5)

large8 Key Encounters

8.1 Tactical Combat Encounter

Battle with Bull Carson and Hollowed Townsfolk tem[Location:] Strongman tent with memory manipulation effects tem[Challenge:] Fighting while resisting memory theft (Spirit vs DV 4 each round) tem[Complications:]

tem Allies among enemies (hollowed friends/family) tem Environmental hazards (falling weights, crowd control) tem Memory confusion effects (1 die to recognition rolls)

tem[Position:] Desperate (surrounded), may improve with strategy tem[DV:] 5 (combat), 4 (tactical approach)

8.2 Exploration Scene

Navigating EverShifting Carnival Grounds tem[Challenge:] Paths loop and landmarks become threatening tem[Skills:] Survival + Notice vs DV 4 to navigate successfully tem[Hazards:]

tem Spatial disorientation (lose 1 Move per failed check) tem Hidden threats in familiar areas tem Time distortion effects (actions take longer)

tem[Rewards:] Shortcuts to key areas, hidden items, escape routes

8.3 Social Negotiation

Negotiating with Madame Zara tem[Challenge:] Gain information while avoiding wish traps tem[Skills:] Sway + Insight vs DV 5 tem[Dangers:]

tem Subtle wish temptation (mark 1 Wish Corruption) tem Misinformation leading to traps tem Emotional manipulation based on PC fears

tem[Success Rewards:] Carnival operational knowledge, lieutenant weaknesses

8.4 SetPiece Challenge

Carousel of Echoes Escape tem[Challenge:] Race against time to escape memory theft tem[Mechanics:] Extended Athletics + Wits challenge, DV 5 tem[Effects:]

tem Memory loss per failed check (lose 1 skill temporarily) tem Physical strain (mark 1 Fatigue) tem Time pressure (Hollowing Timer advances +1)

tem[Complications:] Carousel speeds up, exits move, illusions confuse

8.5 Skill Challenge

Disabling DreamWeaving Machinery tem[Location:] Carnival back areas with supernatural security tem[Challenge:] Technical sabotage under pressure tem[Skills:] Tinker + Arcana vs DV 6 tem[Security Measures:]

tem Supernatural guardians (outsider constructs) tem Illusory defenses (false layouts, hidden dangers) tem Time constraints (Hollowing Timer +1 per failed attempt)

tem[Success Effects:] Weaken carnival, gain inside knowledge, rescue victims

large9 Key Mechanics

9.1 Hollowing Timer [6]

tem[Advance +1:] Carnival operates normally, minor memory theft tem[Advance +1:] Townspeople show first signs of hollowing tem[Advance +2:] Hollowed townsfolk become active threats tem[Advance +1:] PCs accept wishes or fail to stop memory theft tem[Advance +1:] Carnival Master grows stronger tem[When Full:] Town's collective memories consumed, carnival ascends

9.2 Memory Fragments Track

tem[Collection:] PCs can collect stolen memories as assets tem[Benefits:]
 tem Gain insights into carnival operations tem Temporary skill boosts related to memory content tem Leverage against hollowed townspeople
 tem[Costs:]
 tem Emotional baggage (1 die to related social rolls) tem Identity confusion (difficulty distinguishing real memories) tem Vulnerability to memory manipulation
 tem[Maximum:] 5 fragments per PC (reduce to 2 at scene end)

9.3 Wish Corruption

tem[Gains:] Each wish grants power but creates weakness tem[Effects:]
 tem +1 die to one skill for scene tem Gain specific supernatural ability temporarily tem Improved Position for related actions
 tem[Corruption:]
 tem Corresponding vulnerability or moral compromise tem Mark 1 segment on Corruption Timer tem Increased susceptibility to carnival influence
 tem[Limit:] Maximum 3 wishes per PC per adventure

9.4 Dream Echoes

tem[Manifestation:] PCs experience dreams of other victims' memories tem[Benefits:]
 tem Gain insight into carnival's methods tem Forewarning of dangers tem Understanding of victims' motivations
 tem[Risks:]
 tem Risk to own identity (confusion between real and borrowed memories) tem Emotional trauma from victims' experiences tem Vulnerability to carnival influence during dreams
 tem[Control:] Requires Spirit + Resolve vs DV 4 to maintain self during echoes

large10 Stakes and Consequences

10.1 Success Outcomes

tem Carnival destroyed or reformed tem Memories restored to willing victims tem Town left with trauma but intact tem PCs gain reputation as protectors tem Potential allies in Granny Moira and Mayor Vasquez

10.2 Failure Outcomes

tem Carnival consumes town's memories tem Everyone becomes hollow shells tem Carnival moves on with increased power tem PCs lose hometown connections tem New recurring supernatural threat

10.3 Walk Away Outcomes

tem Carnival succeeds in Millhaven tem Grows stronger for future encounters tem PCs' hometown connections lost tem Moral weight of abandonment tem Adventure becomes ongoing campaign thread

11 Midpoint Twist

11.1 The Revelation

Halfway through Night 2, PCs discover that one of their own has been making wishes at the carnival, and their memories are already compromised.

11.2 Immediate Consequences

tem Compromised PC gains Wish Corruption segment tem Other PCs must decide whether to trust this PC tem Carnival now has inside knowledge of party dynamics tem Hollowing Timer advances +1 due to betrayal

11.3 Resolution Options

tem Confront and potentially exclude compromised PC tem Work together to overcome the compromise tem Use compromise as tactical advantage against carnival tem Allow PC to make redemption choice

12 Player Spotlights

12.1 Investigator/Tracker PC

tem Use skills to uncover carnival's pattern of previous victims tem Connect current events to historical records tem Identify key operational patterns and weaknesses tem Opportunity for extended investigation scenes

12.2 Magic User PC

tem Face moral dilemma about using carnival magic against carnival tem Potential for corruption or power gain tem Unique insights into supernatural nature of threat tem Opportunity to directly combat Carnival Master

12.3 Social/Charismatic PC

tem Convince hollowed loved ones to remember true selves tem Navigate complex emotional negotiations tem Potential to turn enemies into allies tem Handle key social encounters with lieutenants

12.4 Combat Specialist PC

tem Direct confrontation with supernatural threats tem Protect civilians from hollowed townsfolk tem Opportunity for tactical combat encounters tem Physical challenges against Bull Carson

12.5 Stealth/Skill PC

tem Infiltrate backstage areas undetected tem Disable memorystealing machinery tem Gather intelligence without alerting enemies tem Handle technical challenges and traps

13 Final Confrontation

13.1 SetPiece: Dream Consumption Ritual

tem Location: Central carnival tent with swirling vortex of stolen memories tem Effect: Carnival Master grows more powerful as townspeople drawn in tem Challenge: Multiple simultaneous threats (Master, hollowed townsfolk, environmental hazards) tem Time Pressure: Hollowing Timer fills during encounter

13.2 Defining Choice

To destroy the carnival completely (saving town but losing power) or make one final wish to become carnival's new masters (gaining power but unknown cost to humanity).

13.3 Resolution Paths

tem **Destruction:** Complex ritual requiring sacrifice, memory restoration, breaking collective belief tem **Mastery:** Temptation requiring moral compromise, potential for future corruption tem **Reformation:** Transform carnival into force for good, ongoing responsibility tem **Escape:** Save some townspeople but leave threat unresolved

14 Aftermath and Ripple Effects

14.1 Character Changes

tem PCs gain or lose memories based on choices tem Hollowed townspeople slowly recover (or don't, becoming NPCs) tem Granny Moira reveals more of her true nature and age tem Mayor Vasquez deals with political fallout

14.2 Alliance Shifts

tem Strong bond with Granny Moira if she survives tem Tension with townspeople who made regretted wishes tem Potential rivalry with other monster hunters arriving late tem New understanding of supernatural threats

14.3 Adventure Seeds

tem Other carnival fragments survived elsewhere tem Granny Moira's past with similar threats tem Carnival Master's origins in realm of forgotten dreams tem PCs' compromised memories resurface later tem New carnival appears in different location

15 Session Structure

15.1 Session 1: The Carnival Arrives (Night 1)

tem PCs receive mysterious invitations tem Investigate carnival's arrival and initial effects tem Meet key NPCs (Mayor, Granny Moira) tem Experience first minor memory thefts tem Advance Hollowing Timer +1

15.2 Session 2: Deeper Involvement (Night 2)

tem Investigate carnival operations more deeply tem Confront hollowed townspeople tem Introduce Midpoint Twist (compromised PC) tem Major combat or skill challenge encounter tem Advance Hollowing Timer +2

15.3 Session 3: Crisis Point (Night 3)

tem Final preparations for carnival's climax tem Rescue remaining townspeople tem Confront lieutenants and disable key machinery tem Advance Hollowing Timer toward full

15.4 Session 4: Final Confrontation

tem Dream Consumption Ritual in central tent tem Defining choice about carnival's fate tem Resolution of all major plot threads tem Determine longterm consequences tem Set up future adventure seeds

16 GM Notes

16.1 Atmosphere Guidance

tem Emphasize sensory details: offkey music, metallic smells, wrong shadows tem Create cognitive dissonance: beautiful carnival masking horror tem Use lighting effects: increasing darkness, flickering lanterns tem Make time feel distorted: nights that seem too long

16.2 Memory Mechanics

- tem Players may forget real details about their characters
- tem Distinguish between real and false memories becomes challenging
- tem Use confusion to create tension without frustrating players
- tem Provide clear mechanical indicators of memory compromise

16.3 Horror Elements

- tem Psychological horror over gore
- tem Loss of identity more frightening than death
- tem Familiar becoming threatening
- tem Moral ambiguity in choices

16.4 Scaling for Tiers

- tem **Tier I:** Reduce entity Caps, simplify ritual requirements, provide more NPC assistance
- tem **Tier II:** Standard challenges, full complexity, moderate supernatural threats
- tem **Tier III+:** Add political complications, increase entity power, complicate resolution